Being

"The true, the good and the one are said first of God, and of creatures by participation. We come to know God from his effects, so the road runs from things to him."

The kind of answer: said by analogy · Being on the map

In a child's words. Some words, like good and true, belong first to God and then to us. We learn what they mean from the things around us, and follow the road back to him.

The Institute habit

A word used in two senses without saying so. The Executives told the new students there were no rules, then listed the rules. Analogy is the honest opposite: one word, related senses, and the relation said out loud.

The book

Nicholas's hunt widens: telescopes, newspaper clippings, a manor and its library.

Week 1 · the kind of answer

"Good" said of a knife, a dog, a man and God. Sort twenty sentences into three piles: the same sense, unrelated senses (the Executives' trick), and related senses (analogy).

Week 2 · into the gap

Being is the last gap on the map. The child writes into it in Reynie's voice, answering the question from his first test, "Are you brave?": what brave means said of a lion, a boy and a saint.

Week 3 · the case

Put God on the top rung of Unit 6's ladder, above the angel, and the picture is wrong: God is not the biggest thing in the series but the cause of the whole series, and the road runs from things to him. Compare Mr. Curtain's title for himself, Minister And Secretary of all The Earth's Regions: a man trying to be the top rung.

Fridays

Spot the Whisperer: one word in an advertisement that changes its meaning halfway through.

PUBLIC DOMAIN To the extent possible under law, Richard Verver has waived all copyright and related or neighbouring rights to this page under CC0 1.0 Universal. You may copy, change, translate, print and share it, for any purpose, without asking. Quotations from other writers keep their own terms.

Read online at canon-lawyer.ca/curriculum/being/.